GawdSpeed

Practice & transcription player · Guide

Slow a song down or speed it up without changing its key, loop the hard part, and work it out by ear. Hold the pointer over any control for a tooltip.



1. **Open…** a song or video (⌘O), or drag a file onto the window: WAV, MP3, FLAC, AIFF, M4A, OGG, Opus, MP4, MOV and more.
2. **Link field.** Paste a YouTube, SoundCloud, Bandcamp or Vimeo link and press **Return** (⌘U jumps here). The audio goes to Music ▸ GawdSpeed ▸ Downloads. The first time, GawdSpeed sets up the free yt-dlp tool it uses.
3. **Regions.** Named sections of this song, like “Bridge lick”. Highlight a section and save it here (⌘D); later, jump back to it or loop it. They show as orange bars on the overview.
4. **Algorithm A | B.** Two ways of slowing audio down. Try both: one may sound better on a given song.
5. **Overview.** The whole song. The box shows what the big waveform is showing; drag it to move around.
6. **Waveform.** Click to jump; drag across it to highlight a section (a click outside the highlight clears it). Pinch, ⌘ -scroll or ⌘+ / ⌘– to zoom; scroll to move. Right-click for more.
7. **The highlight.** Drag its edges, or its middle, to adjust it. Edges snap to where the wave crosses zero, which keeps loops click-free.
8. **Transport.** Back to start (or the loop’s start), back 5 s, play / pause (**Space**), ahead 5 s, and where you are in the song, in the song’s own time whatever the speed.
9. **Loop, In, Out, ✕.** Loop repeats the highlight (**L**). **I** and **O** set the start and end at the playhead, or click a time to type one. ✕ (or **Esc**) clears the highlight.
10. **Export…** (⌘E) saves the slowed-down audio as a new file (the whole song or the highlight) as WAV, AIFF, FLAC, ALAC, AAC or MP3. The original is never changed.
11. **Speed.** 25% to 200%, and the key stays the same; 100% is normal. **–** / **=** change it by 5% (⌥ for 1%); the buttons from 50 to 200 jump straight there.
12. **transpose and tune.** Change the key without changing the speed: transpose in semitones (**[** / **]**); tune in cents, for recordings slightly sharp or flat (⌥[/ ⌥]).
13. **original key.** Appears only while the key is shifted. Click it (or ⌘0) to go back.
14. **High-pass and low-pass.** High-pass cuts bass (turn it up); low-pass cuts treble (turn it down). Drag or scroll; double-click to switch off. Handy for picking out a bass line or a hi-hat part.

Your first loop, in 30 seconds

1. Drag a song onto the window.
2. Click **75** (or drag the speed slider).
3. Drag across the hard part of the waveform to highlight it.
4. Press **L** to loop it, then **Space** to play.
5. When it's comfortable, nudge the speed up with **=**.

GawdSpeed remembers each song: speed, key, filters, loop, regions and where you were come back when you open it again. **⌘Z** undoes changes to the controls and the loop.

Settings (⌘,)

Snap loop points to zero crossings	On by default; avoids clicks at the loop point.
Loop pre-roll	Starts each pass up to 2 s early, for a run-up.
Follow the playhead	Page by page, or smooth scrolling.
Play through	Which speakers, headphones or interface to use.
Import from websites	Where yt-dlp is, update it, where downloads go.
Algorithm A: lighter preset	Uses less processing; try it on an older Mac.

Keyboard shortcuts

Space	Play / pause
Return	Back to the loop start, or the song's start
← **→**	Back / ahead 1 s (⇧ 5 s, ⌥ 0.1 s)
– **=**	Slower / faster by 5% (⌥ 1%)
[**]**	Transpose down / up a semitone
⌥[**⌥]**	Tune down / up 5 cents
⌘0	Back to the original key
I **O**	Loop start / end at the playhead
L	Loop on / off
Esc	Clear the highlight
⌘D	Save the highlight as a region
⌘+ **⌘–**	Zoom in / out
⌘O **⌘U** **⌘E**	Open a file / a link · Export
⌘Z **⇧⌘Z**	Undo / redo
?	Show all shortcuts in the app

Good to know

At 100% speed with no key change, GawdSpeed plays the original audio untouched. Only download audio you have the right to use. Help ▸ Show Tips replays the first-run tips.

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